

CAREER LAUNCH SERIES · SESSION 4

AI-Powered Interview Preparation

The complete prompt playbook, frameworks, worked examples, mock-interview lab, and readiness checklist for IT engineers — from Nepal to the global market.

Audience	Fresh graduates, bachelor-level students, and entry-to-mid-level IT professionals in Nepal and abroad.
Target roles	IT Support, Network, Cloud, DevOps, SOC / Security, Database, Python / Developer.
Markets	Nepal domestic market, India, GCC, US, EU, and global/remote hiring.
Format	Live workshop, flexible 3 to 5 hours, with take-home practice routines.
Outcome	A personal AI interview-prep workflow students can reuse for every future job, not just one interview.

The core rule

AI must not manufacture fake experience. AI helps students discover, structure, test, and improve the experience they actually have. In an interview, honesty and clear reasoning always beat a memorized, shallow answer.

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Mentor · Educational Activist

10K Skilled Engineer Mission | Nepal to Global Markets

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2. Readiness Diagnostic	Score yourself on 7 quick checks, so you know your own weak spots before we start fixing them.
3. Nepal & Global Interview Stacks	Learn the exact stages of a Nepal interview and a global/remote interview — referral calls, ATS, AI screens, take-home tasks, panels — so you prepare for the right pipeline, not a guess.
4. Background Research with AI	Get ready-to-use prompts that decode any company and job description in minutes — pulling out the must-have skills, likely questions, and smart questions to ask back.
5. Fresher Evidence Bank	Turn your labs, college projects, Packet Tracer, Linux/cloud practice, and GitHub into real interview proof — so "I have no experience" stops being your excuse.
6. Behavioral & HR Rounds	Master four answer frameworks (STAR , SOAR , CAR , PREP), build your 8-story bank, and see full model answers to common HR questions — so you never ramble or freeze.
7. Technical Foundations & Troubleshooting	Learn the six-layer method to answer any technical question, plus a step-by-step troubleshooting funnel for networking, Linux, and cloud scenarios.
8. Role-Specific Preparation Tracks	Get a focused prep list and real scenario drills for your track — IT Support, Network, SOC, Cloud, DevOps, Database, or Python/Developer.
9. The Master AI Prompt Library	Take home a complete set of copy-paste prompts that turn any AI tool into your personal interviewer, answer-critic, and mock-panel — reusable for every future job.
10. The Mock Interview Lab	Practice live in groups of three (Candidate, Interviewer, Evaluator) using a scoring rubric.
11. Global & AI-Screening Track	Learn how one-way AI video screens score you, how to communicate across time zones in writing, and how to handle live-coding rounds — formats local hiring never shows you.
12. Bonus Point: Salary & Offer Conversation	Learn a four-turn script so you don't leak value or accept too fast, and how to read a global offer.
13. Readiness Checklist, Tools & Resources	Get a go/no-go checklist, and a curated shelf of AI tools, mock platforms, and free practice sites to keep improving after today.
14. Ethics, FAQs & Common Mistakes	Learn the honesty rules for AI use, the mistakes that get candidates rejected, and clear answers to the questions every fresher asks.
15. References & Closing Message	The research and official sources behind this guide, and a closing note on the path from Nepal to the global market.

1. Why This Session Matters

In the previous sessions of the [Career Launch Series](#), students built a stronger CV and an optimized [LinkedIn profile](#) (first watch the CV session before continuing this).

The recruiter can now find them. This session answers the harder question: when they are called for the interview, can they stand out and convert?

Most candidates do not lose interviews because they know nothing. They lose because they cannot structure what they know under pressure. The fix is not only more facts. It is preparation, structure, rehearsal, evidence, and honest self-correction, and modern AI tools make that rehearsal available to every student, free, at any hour.

This guide treats AI as a coach and sparring partner (अभ्यास गर्ने साथी), not a script writer. If used well, AI helps candidates discover, structure, test, and improve their real experience. It must not invent experience for them.

Teaching goal

By the end, every student should have a reusable interview-preparation system: research the role, build evidence, prepare HR stories, answer technical questions in layers, run mock interviews with AI, and speak honestly under pressure.

Note:

For a comprehensive, domain-specific list of questions and answers, please refer to the [Questions Bank PDF for Interview Preparation](#) after this session.

2. Readiness Diagnostic

2.1 Five-Minute Interview Readiness Diagnostic

Ask students to score themselves 1 to 5 on each line. This makes the pain visible before the solution is taught — and gives them a baseline to measure against at the end of the session.

1. I can introduce myself in 60 seconds without reading.
2. I can explain one real project, lab, or internship clearly.
3. I can answer "Why should we hire you?" with evidence.
4. I can troubleshoot a basic network, Linux, or cloud issue step by step.
5. I can answer honestly when I do not know something.
6. I can speak for two minutes without filler words or panic.
7. I can ask three smart questions to the interviewer.

Note: If you scored high, you already have a strong starting point. If not, this session will help you close the gap through structured practice, honest feedback, and AI-assisted rehearsal.

3. Nepal and Global Interview Stacks

Students preparing from Nepal often make one major mistake: they prepare for only one type of hiring flow. **Nepal hiring, India / GCC hiring, and global remote hiring reward different behaviors.** A candidate who understands the pipeline prepares with better precision.

3.1 Nepal Interview Stack

Nepal stage	What usually happens	How to prepare
Referral / personal network	Many openings move through seniors, training institutes, LinkedIn, or Facebook groups.	Ready a short intro, updated CV, LinkedIn, and proof of labs/projects.
Direct HR call or walk-in	HR checks availability, salary expectations, communication, and attitude.	Practice the 60-second intro, salary range, location flexibility, and role interest.
Written / basic technical test	Common for freshers: networking basics, Linux commands, fundamentals, MCQs.	Revise fundamentals, commands, subnetting, OSI, DNS, DHCP, ports, ticketing.
First technical interview	Tests fundamentals, attitude, and whether you can explain clearly.	Use the layered answer template and the troubleshooting funnel.
Manager / senior round	Tests reliability, learning attitude, and trust with users or clients.	Prepare STAR stories, the unknown-answer framework, and smart questions.
Salary & joining discussion	Often quick and direct; freshers may accept too fast.	Know your range; ask about shift, probation, training, bond, benefits, growth.

3.2 Global / Remote Interview Stack

Global stage	What usually happens	How to prepare
Online application & ATS	Resume and LinkedIn screened for role match, keywords, and clarity.	Use JD language honestly; keep formatting clean.
Recruiter screen	Recruiter checks fit, communication, salary range, notice period.	Use CAR for short answers and ask about the process.
One-way AI or video screen	Asynchronous video/voice questions before any human round.	Practice timed answers; do not read scripts.
Technical round	Concepts, scenarios, design trade-offs, troubleshooting, or coding.	Use layered answers and explicit "why" reasoning.
Take-home task or lab	Common in developer, DevOps, cloud, security, and remote roles.	Document assumptions, steps, limitations, and trade-offs.

Global stage	What usually happens	How to prepare
Panel / final manager round	Assesses autonomy, communication, ownership, and remote readiness.	Prepare project stories, async examples, and smart questions.
Offer & contract model	May involve direct contract, EOR, contractor, or regional payroll.	Clarify gross vs net, benefits, taxes, review cycle, and working hours.

3.3 Nepal vs. Global: The Honest Comparison

Dimension	Typical Nepal market	Typical global/remote market
First contact	Referral, walk-in, direct HR call, institute network.	Online application, recruiter search, LinkedIn, ATS, talent platforms.
Screening style	Human call; basic fit, attitude, certification, availability.	Automated screen, structured recruiter call, written communication, proof of work.
Interview speed	Often faster, sometimes informal.	Often longer, asynchronous, multiple rounds across time zones.
What is weighted	Fundamentals, certificate, attitude, willingness to learn.	Autonomy, written clarity, projects, GitHub/labs, remote maturity.
Common mistake	Speaking too casually, weak fundamentals, no project proof.	Generic answers, weak written English, unclear time zone, no remote readiness.
Nepali student edge	Low-cost home labs; strong English-content access; community support.	Morning-hours overlap with GCC and EU; competitive cost; proof-of-work culture rewards self-taught skill.

4. Background Research with AI

Before preparing answers, candidates must understand who they are interviewing with and what the role really needs. Strong candidates walk in already fluent in the company's business, the role's responsibilities, the interviewer's context, and the likely pain points.

4.1 What to Research

- **Company:** business model, products, services, customers, recent news, leadership, culture.
- **Role:** required skills, daily responsibilities, growth path, and hidden expectations.
- **Interviewer:** LinkedIn profile, team, technical background, public posts, likely priorities.
- **Industry:** competitors, current trends, compliance pressure, common operational problems.

4.2 Prompt: Company Research

Paste the company name and job description. Works on ChatGPT, Claude, or Gemini.

You are a senior career coach with 15 years of experience preparing candidates for IT interviews across Nepal, India, the GCC, and global remote markets. Research [COMPANY NAME] and prepare me for [ROLE]. Give me:

1. Company snapshot: business model, products, scale, and recent news.
2. Three strengths the company is known for.
3. Two challenges or risks they likely face.
4. Three industry trends that affect this company.
5. Five talking points that show I have done my homework.
6. Three thoughtful questions I can ask at the end.

Rules: use only public information; if unsure, say so. Keep every point concrete. Output as a clean checklist.

4.3 Prompt: Decode the Job Description

You are an experienced technical recruiter for [ROLE TYPE]. Below is a job description. Do the following:

1. Extract the 5 must-have skills, ranked by likelihood of being tested.
2. Extract good-to-have skills and tools.
3. List the 10 most likely interview questions for this JD.
4. Identify hidden expectations not written down but standard for this role.
5. Give me a 7-day preparation plan with daily focus areas.

Output as a markdown table where useful. Be specific, not generic.

JOB DESCRIPTION:

```
"""
[PASTE FULL JD HERE]
"""
```

Trainer tip

Do not ask AI to "prepare me for this job." Ask it to **extract, predict, simulate, score, and improve**. Treat the prompt like a project brief, not a wish.

5. Experience Without a Job

Freshers often say, "I do not have experience." That is not the real problem. The real problem is that they have not converted learning into interview evidence. A fresher cannot create fake experience, but can absolutely show labs, documentation, projects, troubleshooting thinking, and learning discipline.

5.1 What Counts as Evidence

Evidence type	Examples students can use
College project	Final-year project, mini project, database project, Python project, web or mobile app, IoT project.
Lab practice	Packet Tracer, GNS3, EVE-NG, a Linux VM, a Windows Server lab, a cloud free-tier lab.
Security practice	TryHackMe, CTF notes, a phishing-awareness project, log analysis, a basic SIEM lab.
Documentation	Network diagram, troubleshooting checklist, installation guide, command notes, runbook.
Volunteer work	College IT support, community training, cyber awareness, basic IT setup for an organization.
GitHub / portfolio	Code, README, screenshots, architecture diagram, project notes, issue log.

5.2 Project Explanation Template

Fill this for each project before the interview. It becomes the raw material for your stories in Section 6.

- **Project name:** what did you build or practice?
- **Problem solved:** what issue or learning goal did it address?
- **Tools used:** which OS, language, platform, protocol, or cloud service?
- **Your exact contribution:** what did you personally configure, code, test, or document?
- **Challenge:** what broke or confused you?
- **Fix:** how did you troubleshoot it?
- **Result:** what worked in the end? Add a screenshot, GitHub link, diagram, or notes.
- **Learning:** what would you improve next time?

5.3 Example: Fresher Network Lab Story

Sample answer

"In my Packet Tracer lab, I designed a small office network with two VLANs for Admin and Students, and configured inter-VLAN routing, DHCP, and basic access control. My first issue was that clients in VLAN 20 were not receiving IP addresses. I checked VLAN assignment, trunk status, the DHCP pool, and the gateway configuration, then found the helper address was missing on the routed interface. After fixing it, both VLANs received IP addresses and could reach only the allowed services. This taught me that troubleshooting should follow the layer and the evidence, not guesswork."

6. Behavioral and HR Rounds: Frameworks and Examples

Behavioral interviews evaluate your professional skills, such as problem-solving, communication, and critical thinking, by focusing on your past actions. Interviewers seek concrete evidence of ownership and results, rather than your personal stories. Research in personnel psychology shows structured behavioral interviews predict job performance far better than unstructured conversations. Using structured frameworks helps you present your experience clearly and prevents rambling.

6.1 Four Frameworks You Need

Framework	Meaning	Best for	Trigger question
STAR	Situation, Task, Action, Result	General behavioral questions	Tell me about a time you led, solved, or achieved something.
SOAR	Situation, Obstacle, Action, Result	Failure, weakness, conflict	Tell me about a time you failed or faced a challenge.
CAR	Context, Action, Result	Short HR or AI-screen answers	Give a quick example in 30–45 seconds.
PREP	Point, Reason, Example, Point	Opinion and culture questions	What is your work style? How do you handle disagreement?

6.2 STAR Example

Question: Tell me about a time you solved a technical problem.

STAR model answer

Situation: During my college network lab, our group could not get users from one VLAN to reach the server VLAN.

Task: I was responsible for checking the VLAN and routing configuration.

Action: I verified VLAN membership, trunk ports, gateway IPs, and routing. I found the trunk allowed only one VLAN, so the second VLAN's traffic was blocked. I updated the allowed VLAN list, tested ping and application access, and documented the steps.

Result: The lab worked, and our group reused the checklist in the next practical session.

6.3 SOAR Example

Question: Tell me about a time you made a mistake.

SOAR model answer

Situation: In an early Linux lab, I edited a service configuration file without taking a backup.

Obstacle: The service failed to start, and I did not immediately know which line caused it.

Action: I checked the service status, reviewed logs with journalctl, compared the file with the documentation, and corrected the syntax. After that, I kept backups before editing config files.

Result: The service started successfully, and I adopted a safer change management process: backup, edit, test, verify, document.

6.4 CAR Example

Question: How do you handle pressure?

CAR model answer

Context: During exam week, I had to finish a Python project and prepare for a networking practical.

Action: I broke the work into smaller tasks, fixed the most urgent errors first, and asked a teammate to review the final output.

Result: We submitted on time, and I learned that pressure becomes manageable when I prioritize, communicate early, and avoid last-minute guessing.

6.5 PREP Example

Question: Do you prefer speed work or documentation?

PREP model answer

Point: I prefer speed with minimum useful documentation, not speed without documentation.

Reason: In IT support and engineering, undocumented fixes create repeated problems for the next engineer.

Example: In my Linux lab, I documented the exact service restart and log-checking steps, so I could repeat the fix quickly later.

Point: So I solve quickly, but always leave enough notes for the team and future troubleshooting.

These examples are just a starting point. Practicing more questions with these frameworks will help keep your answers structured, clear, and relevant to the interview questions.

6.6 The 8 stories students should prepare

Prepare eight versatile stories from your own life. Almost every **behavioral question** maps to one of these. Once they are ready, you recombine and reuse them, telling each in CAR (short) or STAR (full) form on demand.

- Leadership or initiative without authority.

For example: this is a story about a student who took responsibility even when they were not the official leader.

A student noticed that the group project was delayed, so they created a task list, divided work, followed up with members, and helped submit the project on time.

Use for questions like:

“Tell me about a time you showed leadership.”

“Have you ever taken initiative?”

“Why should we hire you?”

Create a story in the same way for the remaining questions based on your experience.

- Conflict with a peer, manager, or stakeholder.
- A failure or mistake you owned and corrected.
- A significant success with measurable impact.
- Teamwork or cross-functional collaboration.
- A tight deadline or high-pressure situation.
- Ambiguity, missing information, or unclear goals.
- Learning a new skill or technology fast.

6.7 Sample HR Answers For a comprehensive, domain-specific list of questions and answers, please refer to the *Questions Bank PDF for Interview Preparation*.

Question	Answer anatomy and reference answer
Tell me about yourself	Identity, evidence, direction. "I am a final-year IT student focused on networking and cybersecurity. I have built labs in routing, switching, Linux basics, and troubleshooting, and recently documented a small VLAN, DHCP, and DNS lab in Packet Tracer. I am now looking for an entry-level IT Support or Network Support role where I can apply my fundamentals, learn from real production environments, and grow toward network security."
Why should we hire you?	Match role needs with proof. "I bring strong fundamentals, learning discipline, and a support mindset. I have practised networking, Linux, and troubleshooting labs, and I can explain issues clearly instead of guessing. As a fresher I do not claim to know everything, but I learn fast, document properly, and escalate with evidence."
What is your weakness?	A real but controlled weakness. "Earlier, I spent too long trying to solve everything alone. I realized that in IT, escalation with evidence is not weakness. Now I troubleshoot systematically, collect logs or screenshots, document what I tried, and then ask for help if needed."
What if you do not know the answer?	Honesty plus method. "I have not worked deeply on that yet, but my understanding is that it relates to [basic concept]. I would verify through official documentation, logs, and a lab test rather than guess. After the interview, I would reproduce the scenario and learn it properly."

7. Technical Foundations and Troubleshooting

Every IT interview tests fundamentals, but strong candidates do more than define terms. They explain how something works, give a real example, troubleshoot the failure, mention trade-offs, and connect it to the job.

Domain	Must-know interview areas	Common question
Networking	OSI / TCP-IP, IP addressing, subnetting, DNS, DHCP, NAT, routing, VLAN, VPN, ports.	What happens when you type a URL and press Enter?
Systems	Windows / Linux basics, users & groups, services, logs, permissions, patching.	How do you check why a Linux service will not start?
Cloud	IaaS / PaaS / SaaS, VMs, storage, IAM, regions & AZs, security groups, firewalls.	Difference between a security group and a network ACL?
Cybersecurity	CIA triad, MFA, least privilege, phishing, vulnerability vs threat, patching, logs.	Explain the CIA triad with a real example.
DevOps basics	Git, CI/CD concept, containers, monitoring, automation.	Walk me through what a CI/CD pipeline does.
Database basics	SQL vs NoSQL, backup, query basics, access control, indexing.	When would you choose NoSQL over SQL?
ITSM / Support	Ticket lifecycle, SLA, escalation, incident vs request, documentation.	Incident vs service request — what is the difference?
Scripting	Basic Python, Bash, or PowerShell. Read and explain a 20-line script.	What does this script do?

7.1 The Layered Answer Template

Whatever technical question is asked, structure your answer in six layers. This works for freshers and seniors alike — the senior simply goes deeper at each layer.

Layer	What to say	Example for "What is DNS?"
1. Define	One simple definition.	DNS translates human-readable names into IP addresses.
2. How it works	Core process in 2–3 sentences.	Browser checks cache, then resolver, root, TLD, and authoritative DNS.
3. Real example	Tie it to something you have used.	When I open a website, my system queries the configured DNS resolver.
4. Troubleshoot	One thing that can go wrong.	Wrong resolver, stale cache, missing record, or firewall blocking port 53.

Layer	What to say	Example for "What is DNS?"
5. Trade-off	One limitation or design choice.	Caching improves speed but can delay record propagation.
6. Job relevance	Why it matters for the role.	Many "internet down" tickets are actually DNS issues.

7.2 The Universal Troubleshooting Funnel

For any scenario question — "the user cannot reach X", "the service is slow", "the pipeline failed" — interviewers want a structured funnel, not a guess. Run this every time.

1. Clarify the scope: one user or many, one site or all, wired or wireless, internal or internet.
2. Check the obvious: power, cable, Wi-Fi, login, account status, service status, recent change.
3. Isolate the layer: physical, IP, DNS, application, authentication, permission, security policy.
4. Gather evidence: commands, logs, packet capture, monitoring, screenshots, error messages.
5. Form a hypothesis: test it with the smallest safe change.
6. Fix and verify: confirm from the user side and the system side.
7. Document and prevent: update the ticket, runbook, monitoring, and knowledge base.

What interviewers actually score

They score reasoning, trade-offs, communication, and evidence — not just the final answer. "I used Python" is a fact. "I chose Python over Bash because pandas made the data manipulation safer and faster" is a hire signal. Always say why; carry this habit into every role track below.

8. Role-Specific Preparation Tracks

Use the track that matches your target role. Each pairs the focus areas to drill with realistic scenario questions you should be able to walk through using the troubleshooting funnel.

Track	Focus areas	Scenario practice
IT Support	Windows, Linux basics, ticketing, troubleshooting, Active Directory, DNS, DHCP, printers, email, VPN, user communication.	"User cannot access internet"; "password locked"; "VPN not connecting"; "Outlook not syncing".
Network	OSI, subnetting, VLAN, trunk, routing, NAT, ACL, DNS, DHCP, VPN, Wireshark.	"One VLAN cannot reach the server"; "DNS works but app fails"; "packet loss between sites".
SOC / Security	CIA, logs, SIEM, phishing, malware basics, MFA, least privilege, incident response, MITRE ATT&CK basics.	"Phishing alert"; "failed-login spike"; "suspicious PowerShell"; "malware infection".
Cloud	IAM, compute, storage, VPC/VNet, security groups, regions, monitoring, backup, cost basics.	"VM not reachable"; "public access blocked"; "permission denied"; "high cloud bill".
DevOps	Linux, Git, CI/CD, Docker, scripting, monitoring, YAML, basic Kubernetes.	"Pipeline failed"; "container exits"; "deployment rollback"; "disk full on runner".
Python / Developer	Python basics, functions, lists, dictionaries, debugging, Git, APIs, SQL, simple data structures.	Explaining code, debugging errors, and improving simple scripts.

9. The Master AI Prompt Library

These prompts are the core take-home material. Copy them, edit only the placeholders, and use them repeatedly. The goal is not perfect AI-written answers, it is better thinking, better structure, and better speaking practice. Wording matters: prompt-engineering research shows the same task can produce meaningfully different output depending on how it is phrased and which model version you use (Schulhoff et al., 2024–2025).

9.1 RCTFT Prompt Framework

Letter	Element	Example
R	Role	Act as a senior network engineer with 10 years at an MSP.
C	Context	I am a fresh graduate targeting IT Support roles in Kathmandu.
T	Task	Ask me 5 troubleshooting scenarios, one at a time.
F	Format	For each: question, my answer, score, what was missing, model answer.
T	Tone	Be direct and critical. Do not flatter. Treat me as a serious candidate.

9.2 Prompt #1 — Master Interview Coach

You are my strict but supportive AI Interview Coach for IT roles. Help me prepare for real interviews in [select one based on your role: Nepal / India / global remote] markets.

CANDIDATE PROFILE

- Target role: [IT Support / Network / Cloud / DevOps / SOC / Developer]
- Experience level: [fresh graduate / entry-level / mid-level]
- Current skills: [list honest skills]
- Projects, labs, real work: [real evidence only] or attach my CV
- Weak areas: [list honestly]
- Interview round: [HR / behavioral / technical / scenario / final manager]
- Job description: [paste JD if available]

YOUR TASKS

1. Extract the top skills and topics from the role or JD.
2. Ask me one question at a time. Wait for my answer.
3. Grade me 1-10 on correctness, clarity, structure, role relevance, confidence, and technical depth.
4. Flag any incorrect, vague, exaggerated, or unsupported claim.
5. Ask 2 follow-up questions like a real interviewer.
6. Rewrite my answer stronger, using only my real background.
7. After 5 questions, give a final report: strengths, gaps, 7-day plan.

RULES

- Do not invent or assume experience I did not state.
- If my answer is wrong, say exactly what is wrong and how to fix it.
- For scenarios, force me to clarify scope, gather evidence, isolate layers, test hypotheses, propose prevention.
- Keep HR answers 60-90s; technical scenarios 2-4 minutes.

Start by analyzing my role, then ask the first question.

9.3 Prompt #2 Feedback on a user's answer + a corrected version.

You are a senior IT interviewer and coach. I will give you an interview question and my answer. Evaluate my answer honestly and help me improve it.

QUESTION: [paste the interview question]

MY ANSWER:

[paste your answer exactly as you would say it]

Do this in order:

1. SCORE me 1-10 on: correctness, structure, clarity, role relevance, and confidence. One line of justification each.
2. WHAT WORKED: the 2 strongest things in my answer.
3. WHAT'S WEAK: the top 3 problems (e.g. used "we" not "I", no result, vague, factually wrong, rambling). Quote my exact words when you flag them.
4. CORRECTED VERSION: rewrite my answer as a strong 150-word model response. Use ONLY the facts and experience I actually gave you – invent nothing. If my answer was missing something important, mark it clearly as [ADD YOUR REAL EXAMPLE HERE] instead of making it up.
5. FOLLOW-UP: 2 questions a real interviewer would ask me next.

Rules: Be direct and critical, no flattery. If a claim is factually wrong, correct it and tell me the right answer. Do not exaggerate my experience.

9.4 Prompt #3 — "Tell Me About Yourself" Builder

Based on my real background below, write a 60-second "Tell me about yourself" answer for the role of [ROLE] in the [Nepal / India / global remote] market.

Rules:

- Confident, specific, no exaggeration.
- One sentence on identity, one on strongest evidence, one on direction.
- No filler like "I am passionate about" or "hardworking individual".
- Maximum 130-140 words so it fits 60 seconds spoken.
- After the answer, list 3 follow-up questions an interviewer is likely to ask.

MY BACKGROUND:

""

[paste your real background, skills, projects, certifications]

""

9.5 Prompt #4 — STAR Story Critic

You are a structured-interview coach who has trained candidates for global IT roles. Evaluate my behavioral answer against the STAR framework.

Question: [PASTE THE INTERVIEW QUESTION]

My answer:

""

[PASTE YOUR DRAFT ANSWER]

""

1. Identify Situation, Task, Action, Result in my answer. Quote my words.
2. Score each component 1-5 with justification.
3. List the top 3 weaknesses.
4. Rewrite my answer as a model 150-word response that fixes weaknesses but

stays factually consistent. Invent nothing.
 5. Suggest 2 follow-up questions a real interviewer would ask next.
 Tone: direct, professional, no flattery.

9.6 Prompt #5 — Networking / Cloud / Security Scenario Drill

Act as a senior [network / cloud / DevOps / SOC] engineer interviewing me for a [LEVEL] role. Conduct a 5-question oral drill.

Rules:

- One question at a time. Wait for my typed answer before moving on.
- Mix concept questions with scenarios.
- After each answer give: score 1-5, what I got right, what I missed, ideal answer in 3-4 sentences.
- Difficulty ramps up; by Q4 and Q5 I should be working hard.
- After Q5, give a final report card: 3 strengths, 3 weaknesses, 3-day plan. Begin with Question 1 now. No preamble.

9.7 Prompt #6 — The Devil's Advocate

You are a skeptical principal engineer reviewing a junior colleague's answer or design. Your job is to find every weakness.

My answer or design:

""

[paste your answer or design]

""

1. List every assumption I make but did not state explicitly.
 2. List every failure mode I did not address: security, scalability, cost, reliability, vendor lock-in, on-call burden.
 3. Ask 3 follow-up questions a real interviewer would use to expose weak understanding.
 4. Rate me 1-10 on a "would-I-hire" scale and justify in 2 sentences.
- Be ruthless but professional. Assume I want to improve, not be coddled.

9.8 Prompt #7 — Full Panel Mock Interview

ROLE You are a panel of three interviewers:

- Interviewer A: hiring manager, behavioral and cultural fit.
- Interviewer B: principal engineer, technical depth in [PRIMARY DOMAIN].
- Interviewer C: peer engineer, collaboration and communication.

CONTEXT Candidate is applying for [ROLE TITLE] at [COMPANY TYPE].

Experience level: [0-2 / 2-5 / 5+ years].

Background or CV :

""

[paste your background, key skills, one project story, or attach your CV]

""

TASK Run a 5-question mock:

- Q1: tell me about yourself. - Q2: hard technical concept question.
- Q3: troubleshooting scenario. - Q4: behavioral STAR question.
- Q5: closing "why us / why you" question.

RULES One question at a time. Wait for my typed answer. After each, give a 2-3 sentence Panel Note. Do not reveal scores yet.

FINAL REPORT 1. Per-question scores 1-10 with one-line justification.

2. Three strengths. 3. Three improvement areas with one drill each.

4. Honest probability I pass the real round, and what moves the needle most.

5. A 7-day study plan. Begin now with Question 1.

9.9 Prompt #8 — Unknown-Question Handler

Train me to answer interview questions when I do not know the answer.
Step 1: Teach me a 4-line professional structure that shows honesty, reasoning, and willingness to learn, with no bluffing.
Step 2: Ask me 5 hard questions where I am likely not to know.
Step 3: After each attempt, score me on honesty, structure, and how I framed the next step to find the answer.
Step 4: Give me a model answer for each.
Target role: [ROLE]. Level: [LEVEL].

9.10 Prompt #9 — Communication & Filler-Word Coach

You are a communication coach. I will paste my recorded answer transcript.
TRANSCRIPT:
""
[paste transcript]
""

1. Count filler words and list each.
2. Identify any sentence over 25 words and rewrite it shorter.
3. Flag vague phrases and replace them.
4. Output a clean, professional version of my answer at the same length.
5. Give me 3 speaking exercises I can do in 10 minutes today.

10. The Mock Interview Lab

Knowledge does not become interview skill until it is practiced under pressure. (Form groups of three and rotate so every student plays each role at least once. **(This activity should be practiced during the live discussion class.)**)

Role	Responsibility	Focus
Candidate	Answer as if it were a real interview. Speak aloud; do not read.	60–90 seconds for HR, 2–4 minutes for technical scenarios.
Interviewer	Ask one question at a time and press for follow-ups.	Stay neutral. Ask "why?" twice.
Evaluator	Score with the rubric and give feedback at the end.	Quote specific words. Compare to the rubric, not personal taste.

10.1 Scoring Rubric

Criterion	1–2: Weak	3: Average	4–5: Strong
Correctness	Wrong or misleading	Mostly right, small gaps	Accurate, precise, verifiable
Structure	Rambling	Some sequence	Clear framework start to finish
Technical depth	Only keywords	Basic explanation	Trade-offs and troubleshooting included
Role relevance	Generic	Some link to the JD	Strong alignment to role and business need
Communication	Low clarity	Understandable	Calm, confident, well-paced
Authenticity	Exaggerated	Vague evidence	Honest, specific, credible

10.2 Feedback Language for Evaluators

- **Strength:** "Your strongest part was when you..."
- **Gap:** "The answer became weak when you said..."
- **Technical correction:** "One technical point to verify is..."
- **Communication:** "Say this more clearly by..."
- **Next task:** "Before the next mock, practise..."

10.3 Dedicated Mock Interview Platforms

Platform	What it does	Link
Pramp (now Exponent)	Free peer-to-peer mock interviews with real engineers.	tryexponent.com/practice
Interviewing.io	Anonymous mock interviews with engineers from top companies.	interviewing.io
Big Interview	Structured behavioral and technical mock interview training.	biginterview.com
InterviewBit	Practice technical interview questions for programmers.	interviewbit.com

11. Global and AI-Screening Track

This section prepares Nepali candidates for formats they may not see in local hiring: one-way screens, asynchronous updates, remote team communication, and live coding or take-home tasks.

11.1 One-Way AI Video / Voice Screen

Many global employers screen with a one-way asynchronous video interview before any human is involved. You receive a link, complete a tech check, see a question on screen, get a short prep window, then record your answer against a timer. There is no live interviewer.

Why this round is a real gate, not a formality

On many setups, the AI scores and ranks candidates on the verbal content and structure of their answers, and a human reviewer only sees the recordings that clear the AI's threshold. Treat the practice round as seriously as a live interview: a rambling or generic answer can end your application before any person watches it.

- Use the prep window to structure with CAR or STAR before you speak.
- Give a specific, personal example in every behavioral answer — generic answers score poorly.
- Aim to finish 10–15 seconds before the timer; the recording cuts off the instant it hits zero.
- Record in a quiet, well-lit place; test mic, camera, and internet first.
- Never let AI feed you live answers during a real interview. Practise before; perform yourself during.

11.2 Communicating Across Cultures and Time Zones

Global remote teams run on asynchronous, written communication: Slack, pull-request comments, tickets, and short recorded updates. Your written English and clarity of structure matter as much as live speaking — and that rewards preparation over charisma.

- **Clarity over accent.** No one expects a neutral accent; they expect to understand you. Slow down, structure your sentences, and pause between points.
- **Write like an engineer.** Short sentences, clear asks, no walls of text: what happened, what you tried, what you need.
- **Name the time zone, and do the math.** Nepal is UTC+5:45. A "9:00 AM New York (EDT)" call is 6:45 PM in Nepal; a "10:00 AM London" call is 2:45 PM in Nepal. State your zone and offer two concrete slots.
- **Send a follow-up note.** Within 24 hours: thank them, mention one specific thing you discussed, restate your interest. Common abroad, rare in Nepal, and it leaves a strong final impression.

12. Bonus Point: Salary and Offer Conversation

Freshers should not become overconfident negotiators, but they must avoid desperation (विवशता). The goal is professional clarity: understand the offer, avoid leaking value too early, and ask for time to review.

12.1 Before the Call

- Research the market range for the role and location — for global roles, anchor in the role's currency, not your current NPR salary.
- Define three numbers: your ideal, your acceptable, and your walk-away.
- Prepare a one-line justification: skills, certifications, projects, market data.
- Clarify shift, probation, bond, benefits, training, remote policy, and review cycle.
- For global roles, clarify contractor vs EOR, gross vs net, taxes, benefits, and working hours.

Prompt #10 — Salary Negotiation Rehearsal

You are a senior career coach who has guided engineers through salary negotiations in the [Nepal / India / global remote] market. Role-play the HR partner extending an offer to me.

MY SITUATION

- Target role: [ROLE] - Current CTC: [AMOUNT or fresh grad]
- Competing offers: [DETAILS or none] - My target: [AMOUNT]
- Geographic preference: [LOCATION]

Run a 4-turn negotiation:

Turn 1: You offer slightly below my target.

Turn 2: I push back. You react realistically.

Turn 3: You revise or hold firm with reasoning.

Turn 4: We close: I accept, decline, or ask for time.

After the role-play, debrief me: where I leaked value, where I did well, and one phrase I should have used. Use realistic market numbers. No fantasy figures.

13. Final Readiness Checklist, Tools and Resources

13.1 Final Readiness Checklist

You are interview-ready when you can say yes to every line.

- I can introduce myself in 60 seconds without reading from a script.
- I have 8 authentic stories ready and can tell each in CAR or STAR form.
- I can explain my strongest project or lab in three layers: what, how, why.
- I can troubleshoot one networking, one cloud, and one Linux scenario step by step.
- I know what I do not know, and I can answer honestly without panic.
- I have three thoughtful questions to ask the interviewer.
- I have run at least one full mock under timed conditions.
- I have practiced a one-way video answer against a timer.
- I have rehearsed the salary conversation and written down my three numbers.

13.2 Tools and Practice Resources

Use the latest available version of each AI tool, model names change every few months, so the capability matters more than the version number.

Area	Recommended resources
AI tools	ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Microsoft Copilot. Use for role-play, critique feedback, JD decoding, and answer rewriting.
Mock platforms	Exponent Practice (formerly Pramp), interviewing.io, Big Interview, InterviewBit.
Networking	CompTIA Network+ N10-009 objectives, Cisco Networking Academy, Packet Tracer.
Cloud	AWS Skill Builder, Microsoft Learn AZ-900, Google Cloud Skills Boost.
DevOps / SRE	Google SRE Books, GitHub Skills, Docker and Kubernetes official docs, KillerCoda.
Coding	LeetCode, HackerRank, Exercism, GitHub projects.
Security	TryHackMe, OWASP, MITRE ATT&CK, vendor documentation.

14. Ethics, FAQs and Common Mistakes

14.1 Honesty Audit: After every AI-assisted prep session, answer these to yourself.

1. Did I actually understand each answer, or did I just memorize it?
2. Can I defend this answer if asked "why?" three times in a row?
3. Did I fact-check every technical claim the AI made?
4. Am I about to claim AI-suggested experience I do not actually have?
5. Could I reproduce this answer without AI tomorrow morning?

What never to do

Never use AI live during a real interview without disclosure. Never paste confidential company data into public AI tools. Never claim a project, tool, or skill you have only seen in a video and cannot defend technically — interviewers find the gap inside 90 seconds.

14.2 Common Mistakes

1. Reading answers like a script instead of speaking naturally.
2. Using "we" for everything and hiding your personal contribution.
3. Giving definitions without examples or troubleshooting context.
4. Overclaiming tools or technologies seen only in YouTube videos.
5. Ignoring Nepal-market realities: referral calls, direct HR calls, walk-ins, joining-date talks.
6. Ignoring global-market realities: ATS, AI screens, written communication, time zones, remote autonomy.
7. Preparing only HR answers and ignoring technical fundamentals.
8. Preparing only technical answers and ignoring communication, ownership, and salary discussion.

14.3 Frequently Asked Questions

Question	Answer
How long should my answers be?	About 60 seconds for HR, 30–45 seconds for quick CAR answers, and 2–4 minutes for technical scenarios.
Should I tailor my resume for each role?	Yes. Match the role honestly with relevant keywords, evidence, projects, and achievements.
Is it okay to say "I do not know"?	Yes. A structured, honest answer beats a confident wrong one. Use Prompt #7 to practice it.
How do I handle a resume gap?	Do not hide it. Give a real reason, what you learned, and how you stayed sharp.
What if AI gives wrong technical info?	Verify commands, product behavior, and vendor specifics against official documentation.
What if I freeze in the interview?	Pause, repeat the question, clarify scope, and use the relevant framework. Practiced students recover; unpractised ones panic.

15. References and Closing Message

15.1 Peer-Reviewed Sources

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15.2 Industry and Vendor Documentation

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9. Microsoft Learn. Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900). learn.microsoft.com/credentials/certifications/azure-fundamentals

15.3 Closing Message

Interview success is built from preparation, truthfulness, daily speaking practice, clear technical reasoning, and the courage to improve weak answers. Use AI every day, but make your own brain stronger every week. The candidate who walks in calm, structured, and honest about what they do not yet know almost always beats the one who walks in confidently wrong.

Keep learning. Keep growing.

— Jiwan Bhattarai, CCIE #60261 —

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